

Question:

A 35-year-old computer programmer presents to the psychiatrist at the request of his mother for his oddities. He explains that he wears an aluminum foil cap while he works because he does not want extraterrestrial life to steal his thoughts. He spends his free time building a radio transmitter to contact distant planets. He denies any delusions or hallucinations. He claims that nothing is wrong with his eccentricities and is happy the way his life is. Which of the following personality disorders does this male most likely have? Answer Choices: A. Schizoid B. Schizotypal C. Paranoid D. Borderline

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> To answer this question, we need to look at the symptoms that the computer programmer is exhibiting. The patient's belief that his thoughts are being stolen by extraterrestrial life is a common symptom of schizotypal personality disorder, which is characterized by a pattern of unusual thought patterns and behaviors. The patient's eccentric behaviors, such as wearing an aluminum foil cap and building a radio transmitter, are also consistent with a diagnosis of schizotypal personality disorder. The patient's denial of any delusions or hallucinations and his claim that nothing is wrong with his behaviors are also consistent with this diagnosis. The schizoid personality disorder is not a good fit for this patient, as he is not avoiding social relationships, which is a common symptom of this disorder. The paranoid personality disorder is also not a good fit, as the patient's beliefs are more related to extraterrestrial life rather than a perceived perception of persecution. The borderline personality disorder is not a good fit, as the patient is not exhibiting any symptoms of impulsivity or emotional instability, which are common symptoms of this disorder. </think> <answer> Schizotypal </answer>

